AN UNSOLICITED FINDINGS NOTE — NO PITCH ATTACHED

Your own cross-reference lists the part. Your own search returns zero.

REPRODUCE IT IN 30 SECONDS — BOTH STEPS ARE ON CAT.COM

Type **WIX 33626** into **parts.cat.com** — you get **zero results**. Now paste **33626** into Caterpillar's own filter cross-reference (**catfiltercrossreference.com**) — it returns the Cat part the shopper wants, **1R-0751**. The data already lives on Caterpillar's own domain; the search box just does not use it.

PARTS.CAT.COM SEARCH
0 / 19
competitor numbers returned a result (measured, live).

CAT'S OWN CROSS-REF
19 / 19
are listed by Caterpillar's own tool as Cat parts.

CAT PART NUMBERS
6 / 6
resolve instantly — they redirect to the product page.

The evidence — what a shopper types, and what Caterpillar returns

Cat part	Filter type	Competitor numbers that should find it	Demand*	Cat search
1R-0751	Fuel Filter	WIX 33626, Baldwin BF7632, Fleetguard FF5324	1,820	**0 results**
1R-0714	Engine Oil Filter	Baldwin B75, WIX 51798, Baldwin B605	1,010	**0 results**
231-0167	Cabin Air Filter	Baldwin RS3542	110	**0 results**
231-0168	Engine Air Filter	Baldwin RS3543	40	**0 results**
1R-1803	Fuel/Water Separator	Baldwin BF7925	20	**0 results**
099-7352	Hydraulic Filter	Baldwin PT8341	—	**0 results**

Six *different* filter types — the gap is not just oil filters, it spans the category. Every competitor number tested returned 0 on parts.cat.com; full list on request. **Cat part** = what Caterpillar's own cross-reference (catfiltercrossreference.com, © Caterpillar) returns for these numbers. *Demand = Google Keyword Planner (US) volume — external, an on-site proxy.

The fix — a data change, not an algorithm rewrite

Index the competitor interchange numbers Caterpillar *already publishes* so the search box resolves them — the same way Cat's own numbers already redirect to the product. A shopper holding a competitor number is the highest-intent buyer on the site, and today gets nothing.

How this was measured, and what it covers

Measured, live. 25 demand-weighted numbers, each run once on the shopper-facing search — Cat 6/6 resolve, competitor 0/19; bot protection respected, no crawling or load; every cross-reference is Caterpillar's own. **Scope.** A deliberate filter-category sample: filters are the canonical cross-reference purchase — a mechanic reads the number off the old part — and Caterpillar publishes an official filter cross-reference, so every mapping here is Cat's own. The same indexing gap applies wherever a buyer arrives with a competitor number (batteries, ground-engaging tools); sizing the dollar opportunity needs Caterpillar's own filter-category sales and traffic mix, which we have not assumed.

If this is worth a look — most likely your **digital commerce / parts ecommerce** team. Happy to send the full 25-term list and the capture log so anyone can reproduce it. No pitch attached.

Northvalley Intelligence LLC ferosh@northvalleyintel.com / +1 (404) 345 0592 / northvalleyintel.com